GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of AYUSH

Blending Traditional Wisdom with Modern Wellness.

Confidential and Proprietory
August 2026

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HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

SHRI PRATAPRAO GANPATRAO JADHAV

HONORABLE MINISTER,

MINISTRY OF AYUSH

MESSAGE



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MESSAGE

India possesses one of the world's richest traditions of holistic healthcare through Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Sowa-Rigpa, and Homoeopathy. As global interest in preventive healthcare, wellness, traditional medicine, and natural therapies continues to grow, the Ministry of AYUSH plays a pivotal role in positioning India as a global leader in integrative healthcare and wellness.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) recognizes the tremendous opportunities that exist in strengthening the AYUSH ecosystem through innovation, research, entrepreneurship, investment, international collaborations, digital health solutions, and wellness tourism. By fostering partnerships among government institutions, healthcare providers, research organizations, educational institutions, startups, and industry stakeholders, CCI India seeks to contribute towards the sustainable expansion of the AYUSH sector.

This Knowledge Paper provides an in-depth understanding of the Ministry's policy framework, institutional initiatives, research priorities, investment opportunities, regulatory landscape, and emerging trends within the AYUSH ecosystem. It also identifies collaborative pathways for strengthening healthcare innovation, medicinal plant cultivation, product commercialization, wellness infrastructure, skill development, and global market access.

The publication is intended to serve policymakers, healthcare professionals, entrepreneurs, investors, academia, pharmaceutical manufacturers, wellness organizations, and development institutions seeking to contribute to India's rapidly expanding traditional healthcare sector. Through informed dialogue and strategic partnerships, it aims to support initiatives that improve healthcare accessibility, generate employment, encourage research, and promote India's traditional systems of medicine worldwide.

As India advances towards becoming a global wellness destination, collaborative efforts between government and industry will remain essential. CCI India remains committed to supporting the Ministry of AYUSH in creating a vibrant, innovation-led, and internationally competitive AYUSH ecosystem.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

PREFACE

India's vision of becoming a **Viksit Bharat by 2047** extends beyond economic prosperity to building a healthier, more resilient, and globally respected nation. At the heart of this vision lies the revival and global advancement of India's traditional systems of medicine, which have served humanity for centuries through holistic, preventive, and sustainable approaches to healthcare. The **Ministry of AYUSH**, as the apex institution responsible for Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Sowa-Rigpa, and Homoeopathy, plays a pivotal role in preserving this civilisational heritage while transforming it into a modern engine of healthcare innovation, economic growth, wellness tourism, research, and global influence.

This Knowledge Paper has been prepared by **CCI India – the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India** as a strategic advisory document to provide a comprehensive understanding of the Ministry's institutional framework, policy initiatives, sectoral progress, investment opportunities, and future growth trajectory. Drawing upon official government publications, policy documents, Budget allocations, national and international research, and global best practices, the paper presents an evidence-based assessment of India's AYUSH ecosystem while identifying high-impact opportunities for collaboration between government, industry, academia, startups, and investors.

The Ministry of AYUSH occupies a uniquely strategic position within India's governance architecture. Beyond promoting traditional medicine systems, it drives research and education, strengthens regulatory frameworks, supports medicinal plant cultivation, expands wellness infrastructure, enhances international cooperation, and positions India as a global leader in holistic healthcare. As worldwide demand for preventive healthcare, natural therapeutics, integrative medicine, and wellness services continues to rise, the Ministry has emerged as a key institution advancing India's soft power, healthcare diplomacy, and bioeconomy.

CCI India envisions itself as a strategic bridge connecting government, industry, research institutions, startups, investors, healthcare providers, and international partners. Through policy advocacy, investment facilitation, startup ecosystem development, export promotion, capacity building, technology adoption, and global partnerships, CCI India seeks to complement the Ministry's efforts in accelerating the growth of India's AYUSH sector. This Knowledge Paper reflects CCI India's commitment to fostering collaborative ecosystems that translate policy vision into measurable economic, healthcare, and societal outcomes.

This document is intended for Union Ministers, Secretaries to the Government of India, NITI Aayog, senior policymakers, State Governments, healthcare institutions, industry leaders, investors, research organisations, multilateral agencies, international wellness organisations, and other stakeholders seeking to engage with India's rapidly evolving AYUSH ecosystem. It aims to serve as a strategic reference for informed decision-making while laying the foundation for long-term collaboration between the Government of India and the private sector in positioning India as the global leader in traditional medicine, wellness, and integrative healthcare.

Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI INDIA)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION TO THE MINISTRY OF AYUSH

1.1 Constitutional Mandate and Governance Role

The Ministry of AYUSH derives its foundational legitimacy from Article 47 of the Constitution of India, which directs the State to raise the level of nutrition and standard of living and to improve public health. Article 51A(f) further enjoins citizens to value and preserve the rich heritage of our composite culture a heritage in which traditional medicine systems are central. These constitutional anchors position AYUSH not as a peripheral health ministry but as a constitutionally mandated custodian of India's civilisational health sovereignty.

The Ministry was carved out as an independent entity from the Department of Indian Systems of Medicine and Homoeopathy (ISM&H), which itself was created in 1995. The elevation to a full Ministry in November 2014 under the National Democratic Alliance government represented a categorical policy statement: that traditional medicine systems would henceforth operate at the highest echelons of India's governance architecture. This structural upgrade brought with it dedicated budgetary allocations, autonomous regulatory authority, and the institutional capacity to drive international engagement.

1.2 Evolution and Institutional Trajectory

The Ministry's evolution reflects India's broader post-independence struggle to balance the modernisation of its health system with the preservation of its indigenous medical heritage. From a largely administrative department in the 1970s managing colleges and councils, it has transformed into a mission-driven ministry with a global footprint, a ₹3,712 crore budget (Union Budget 2024-25), and mandates spanning drug regulation, quality standardisation, international wellness diplomacy, and digital health integration.

The COVID-19 pandemic proved to be a watershed inflection point for the Ministry. The global interest in Ayurvedic immunity protocols, the scientific validation of formulations such as Coronil and polyherbal preparations, and the extraordinary surge in Yoga adoption globally validated the strategic positioning of AYUSH within India's national health architecture. The Ministry's Interdisciplinary AYUSH Research and Development Task Force and the AYUSH-COVID Research Portal established India as a serious scientific actor in traditional medicine, not merely a cultural custodian.

1.3 National Significance and Strategic Positioning

The Ministry of AYUSH occupies a unique position at the intersection of public health, agriculture (medicinal plants), trade (exports of herbal products and Yoga services), education (over 850 colleges and 13 national institutes), tourism (wellness and medical value travel), and foreign policy (WHO Traditional Medicine Strategy, Yoga diplomacy). This multi-sectoral intersection makes AYUSH a ministry with disproportionate cross-cutting impact relative to its budgetary size.

India's AYUSH sector is estimated at approximately USD 18–24 billion domestically and contributes to a global traditional medicine export economy exceeding USD 8 billion annually. The sector employs an estimated 7.5 lakh registered AYUSH practitioners, supports approximately 9,000 licensed AYUSH hospitals, and underpins a medicinal plants value chain that sustains millions of tribal and rural livelihoods. For CCI India, these dimensions collectively represent a strategic engagement opportunity of exceptional scope and depth.

SECTION 2: HISTORICAL TIMELINE OF THE MINISTRY OF AYUSH

The institutional evolution of what is today the Ministry of AYUSH spans over seven decades of independent India. Understanding this trajectory is essential to appreciating both the structural strengths the Ministry brings to its current mandate and the legacy challenges it continues to navigate.

2.1 Historical Milestones Timeline Table

Period	Milestone / Reform	Significance
1947–1969	Committee on Indigenous Systems of Medicine (Chopra Committee, 1946); establishment of Central Council of Indian Medicine (CCIM) Act, 1970	Laid foundations of statutory regulation for Ayurveda, Unani and Siddha practitioners
1970	Indian Medicine Central Council Act passed; Homoeopathy Central Council Act, 1973	Created first statutory bodies for educational standardisation and practitioner registration
1978	First National Health Policy acknowledged role of traditional medicine; WHO Alma Ata Declaration aligned with AYUSH preventive philosophy	Global policy convergence with India's traditional medicine approach
1995	Department of Indian Systems of Medicine & Homoeopathy (ISM&H) created under Ministry of Health	First standalone institutional identity for traditional medicine governance
2003	Renamed to Department of AYUSH; National Policy on ISM&H 2002 operationalised	Formalised acronym; introduced Yoga and Naturopathy into government policy framework
2014	Ministry of AYUSH created; separate from Ministry of Health & Family Welfare	Full ministerial status; independent budget, secretary, and policy authority
2015	First International Day of Yoga (June 21) established via UN Resolution; India proposed	Yoga becomes instrument of cultural diplomacy reaching 177 countries